Three replies, so that no family waits and no family is told nothing. Every family gets one, in writing, within two weeks. The rule underneath all three is Naomi's: **"not this year" is never "not you."** A reply without a written reason and a warm next step is the crossing we are watching for.

Blanks are real blanks. Do not send one unfilled.

---

1. Yes

> Dear _____,
>
> There is a seat for _____ in the Launch Pad's first year, and we would be glad to have them. We start on _____.
>
> Two things come with this letter. The Family note is enclosed for you to countersign, and it says how you leave as plainly as it says anything else. And the other thing is this, which matters more than the seat: **your learner can still say no.** Their yes was given to us on their own, a week after we talked, and it stays theirs to take back. If they change their mind between now and August, tell me and that is the end of it. Nothing is owed and nothing is held against anyone.
>
> If anything in the books or the note reads wrong to you, say so now rather than later.
>
> Erin

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2. We cannot hold this

Before sending: the reason must tie to a specific line in the access statement, and the referral must be a named person or programme with a number, never "look elsewhere." Read by the second adult before it goes. **It must pass the Exhale Test: a family can read it and breathe.**

> Dear _____,
>
> Thank you for telling me honestly what _____ needs. I am writing to say that this room cannot hold it well, and to say why in plain words rather than leave you guessing.
>
> _____ *(the specific limit, tied to the access statement: one guide, no aide, this room, these hours)*
>
> This is a statement about what one guide in one room can provide. It is not a judgement about your learner, and I want to be exact about that because the two are easy to confuse when they arrive in the same envelope.
>
> Here is somewhere I think is worth your call: _____, _____. I have told them you may be in touch. If it would help for me to make that call with you, I will.
>
> Erin

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3. Not this year

Before sending: the method by which the room was filled is stated to families **before** applications open, never explained afterwards. **This is unresolved and is the captain's call** (lottery among those who fit / readiness to start / reasoned choice with a written reason). Fill the blank with the method that was published, in the words it was published in.

> Dear _____,

> _____ fits this room, and there is not a seat this year. I want to be careful about the order of that sentence, because it is the whole of what I am telling you.
>
> More learners fit than the room holds. The room takes _____, and we said before anyone applied how we would choose if this happened: _____. That is what we did, and nothing about it was a reading of your learner against anybody else's.
>
> You are _____ on the list, and the list is a real thing rather than a courtesy. It is where a mid-year seat comes from, and it is where next cycle starts.
>
> And the next door, if you want it before then: _____.
>
> **Not this year is not not you.** I would rather say that in a letter than leave you to wonder.
>
> Erin

The three things that make any of these sendable

1. **A written reason.** Not a category. A sentence a family can argue with.
2. **A real next step.** A named person, a date, a door. Never "look elsewhere."
3. **Read by the second adult before it goes.** On letters 2 and 3 this is binding, not a courtesy. The guide is too close to the sentence that says no.